

SAM Studio — User Guide & Cheat Sheet

Before You Start

Think about the last document you wrote that needed to land with a specific audience — executives, skeptics, new staff, a compliance team, a budget committee. Now imagine having 18 expert reviewers on call, each looking at that document through a different professional lens.

That's what this system gives you. Two prompts. Eighteen perspectives. One workflow that adapts to any document, any audience, any stakes level.

Your First Review (Start Here)

Pick any document you're working on right now. Follow these three steps:

Step 1: Attach these files to Scout:

- 02-COMMANDER-SAM-PERSONA.md

(the reviewer)

- REVIEW-DOCUMENT.md

(the instruction prompt)

- Your document

(what gets reviewed)

Step 2: Type: "review this document"

Step 3: Read what comes back.

That's the system in action. Everything below builds on that first experience.

The Two Commands

Command	What It Does	What You Get Back
REVIEW	Expert feedback through a persona's lens	Structured report: verdict, strengths, findings, scorecard
REWRITE	Full document rewritten in a persona's voice	Complete rewrite with speaker notes + structural change log

How to Invoke: REVIEW-DOCUMENT.md

What to Attach

1. [Persona file]

- tells Scout which expert to become

2. [REVIEW-DOCUMENT.md]

- tells Scout what task to perform

3. [Your document]

- the content that gets reviewed

What to Type

"Review this [document type] using [persona name]"

What You Get Back

```
# [Document name] – Review by [Persona name]

> One-paragraph verdict in the persona's voice

## Strengths
- [2-5 bullets – what works, specifically]

## Findings
### 1. [Issue title] – Slide X / Section Y
**Severity:** Critical / Major / Minor
**Issue:** [What's wrong, from this persona's perspective]
**Recommendation:** [Specific fix, with rewritten text]

## What this persona would ask the author
- [2-4 pointed questions]

## Scorecard
| Dimension | Score (1-5) | Note |
```

Example

Attachments:
- 11-SKEPTIC-PROOF-ANALYST-PERSONA.md
- budget-proposal.pptx
- REVIEW-DOCUMENT.md

Prompt: "Review this budget proposal using Skeptic-Proof Analyst"

How to Invoke: REWRITE-DOCUMENT.md

What to Attach

1. [Persona file]

2. [REWRITE-DOCUMENT.md]

3. [Your document]

– tells Scout which voice to write in

– tells Scout what task to perform

– the content that gets rewritten

What to Type

```
"Rewrite this [document type] using [persona name]"
```

What You Get Back

```
# [Document name] – Rewritten by [Persona name]

## Slide 1: [New title in persona voice]
[On-slide content – concise, shaped by persona]

**Speaker notes:**
[Full narration in persona voice]

---
## Slide 2: [Title]
[Content + speaker notes continue...]

---
## Rewrite notes
### Structural changes made and why:
1. [What changed and rationale]

### [NEEDS: ...] placeholders inserted:
- `[NEEDS: baseline metric]` – Slide 3
```

Example

```
Attachments:
- 15-SALES-PITCH-PERSONA.md
- project-overview.pptx
- REWRITE-DOCUMENT.md

Prompt: "Rewrite this deck using Sales/Pitch persona"
```

Checkpoint: You now understand the two core commands and what they produce. The next section helps you choose the right persona for your situation.

Finding Your Persona

Start With Three Questions

1. **Who is my audience?** (Executives? Peers? New staff? Auditors? A funding committee?)
2. **What do I need from them?** (A decision? Buy-in? Understanding? Compliance sign-off? Budget approval?)

3. **What's my biggest worry about this document?** (Too long? Too technical? Not persuasive? Missing evidence? Ignoring the people affected?)

Your answers point to the persona. Use the table below to match:

Persona Selection Guide

Your Situation	Use This Persona	File
C-suite briefing, 8 minutes max	Executive Briefing · Sam Page	12-EXECUTIVE-BRIEFING-PERSONA.md
Board review, skeptical audience	Skeptic-Proof Analyst · Sam Ledger	11-SKEPTIC-PROOF-ANALYST-PERSONA.md
Team demo, need shared momentum	Energetic Collaborative · Sam Cruz	10-ENERGETIC-COLLABORATIVE-PERSONA.md
Adoption rollout, people are anxious	Empathetic Holistic · Sam Hart	09-EMPATHETIC-HOLISTIC-PERSONA.md
Onboarding, new audience to the topic	Teacher/Explainer · Sam Bell	14-TEACHER-EXPLAINER-PERSONA.md
Funding pitch, vendor proposal	Sales/Pitch · Sam Archer	15-SALES-PITCH-PERSONA.md
Policy or regulatory submission	Legal/Compliance · Sam Clarke	18-LEGAL-COMPLIANCE-PERSONA.md
Post-mortem, incident report, audit	Journalist/Investigative · Sam Bradlee	16-JOURNALIST-INVESTIGATIVE-PERSONA.md
Leadership needs a wake-up call	Commander · Sam Steele	02-COMMANDER-SAM-PERSONA.md
Training video, org history	Documentary Narrator · Sam Atwood	13-DOCUMENTARY-NARRATOR-PERSONA.md
Balanced architecture review	Classic SAM · Sam Wright	01-SAM-PERSONA.md
Interactive workshop, facilitated session	Workshop Facilitator · Sam Rowan	17-WORKSHOP-FACILITATOR-PERSONA.md
Sprint planning, retros, agile docs	Scrum Master · Sam Agile	19-SCRUM-MASTER-PERSONA.md
Product roadmap, user-value alignment	Product Manager · Sam Product	20-PRODUCT-MANAGER-PERSONA.md
Security audit, threat model	Security Auditor · Sam Shield	21-SECURITY-AUDITOR-PERSONA.md
Slide design, accessibility, visual clutter	Design Critique · Sam Pixel	22-DESIGN-CRITIQUE-PERSONA.md

Your Situation	Use This Persona	File
Budget justification, ROI, cost model	Financial Controller · Sam Capital	23-FINANCIAL-CONTROLLER-PERSONA.md
Staff training plan, phased rollout	Change Manager · Sam People	24-CHANGE-MANAGER-PERSONA.md

Still Not Sure?

Tell Scout your situation. It will recommend a persona:

"I'm presenting a new automation tool to skeptical program directors who've seen three prior projects fail. Which persona should I use?"

Checkpoint: You know the two commands and which persona fits your audience. The next section shows patterns for combining them.

Workflows — When to Use Which Pattern

Workflow 1: Get Multiple Perspectives

Use when: Something feels off about your document, but you can't pinpoint what. You want blind spots surfaced before a high-stakes moment.

Round 1: Review with Commander Sam → finds buried verdicts, weak asks
Round 2: Review with Skeptic-Proof Analyst → finds unsupported claims
Round 3: Review with Empathetic Holistic → finds dehumanizing language

Result: Three expert reviews, three different lenses, complete coverage

Workflow 2: Review → Rewrite → Review Again

Use when: The document needs significant improvement and you want a structured path from draft to polished output.

Step 1: Review with Executive Briefing persona → identify critical findings
Step 2: Fix critical findings manually (or ask Scout to fix specific ones)
Step 3: Rewrite entire deck with same persona → get polished output
Step 4: Review the rewrite with Skeptic-Proof Analyst → stress-test it

Result: Polished deck that passes multiple expert standards

Workflow 3: Audience-Specific Versions

Use when: The same content needs to reach different audiences — leadership, staff, compliance — and each group needs a different voice.

Version A: Rewrite with Commander Sam → for skeptical leadership

Version B: Rewrite with Teacher/Explainer → for new staff onboarding

Version C: Rewrite with Sales/Pitch → for the funding committee

Same facts, three voices, three audiences served

Workflow 4: Iterative Refinement

Use when: The document is mostly there, but specific sections need surgical improvement without a full rewrite.

Round 1: Review with [persona] → get findings list

Round 2: "Fix finding #3 on slide 5" → Scout rewrites just that section

Round 3: "Now review slide 5 again" → Scout confirms fix works

Round 4: Repeat for remaining findings

Result: Surgical improvements, section by section

Workflow 5: Cross-Discipline Stress Test

Use when: The document touches multiple concerns — security, budget, adoption, compliance — and each needs validation.

Pass 1: Security Auditor → flags data handling gaps

Pass 2: Financial Controller → validates cost model

Pass 3: Change Manager → checks adoption plan

Pass 4: Legal/Compliance → verifies scope and claims

Result: Document survives every review board in one session

Checkpoint: You now have five workflow patterns. Before moving to advanced tips, ask yourself: do I already know which workflow fits my current project? If yes, skip to Command Templates below. If not, re-read the "Use when" triggers above.

Pro Tips

Tip 1: Request Specific Sections

```
"Rewrite just the opening slide using Energetic Collaborative"  
"Review only the cost section using Financial Controller"
```

You don't always need to process the entire document.

Tip 2: Ask Follow-Up Questions (Scout Stays in Persona)

```
After a review:  
"Why is finding #2 marked Critical instead of Major?"  
"Show me a rewrite of just slide 7 using your recommendations"  
"What would this look like if the audience were non-technical?"
```

Tip 3: Mix Perspectives in One Request

```
"Review this deck using Commander Sam, but also tell me  
what Empathetic Holistic would say about slide 3"
```

Scout gives you both perspectives in one response.

Tip 4: Personas Can Review Other Personas' Work

```
Step 1: Rewrite with Sales/Pitch persona  
Step 2: Review that rewrite with Legal/Compliance persona  
  
Finds: "This sales claim needs a documented basis"
```

This catches overreach and balances persuasion with rigor.

Tip 5: Use [NEEDS: ...] Placeholders as a TODO List

```
After a rewrite, search the output for "[NEEDS:"  
Those are your action items – data you need to fill in.  
Fill them in, paste back, ask Scout to review again.
```

Tip 6: Describe Your Audience for Persona Recommendations

"I'm presenting to a program director who has 10 minutes and cares about cost and compliance. Which persona?"

Scout will recommend the right one and explain why.

Command Templates (Copy-Paste Ready)

Basic Review

Review this [document type] using [persona name] from [persona-file.md]

Basic Rewrite

Rewrite this [document type] using [persona name] from [persona-file.md]

Review Specific Section

Using [persona name], review only [section/slide number] and tell me:

1. What's the severity of issues here?
2. How would you rewrite it?

Compare Two Personas

Review this document from two perspectives:

1. [Persona A] – what are the critical findings?
2. [Persona B] – what would they flag that Persona A missed?

Iterative Fix

I fixed finding #[number] on [slide/section].
Here's the revised version: [paste revision]

Using [persona name], does this fix work? What else needs attention?

Full Cross-Discipline Review

Review this document using these four lenses in sequence:
1. Security Auditor – data handling and trust boundaries
2. Financial Controller – cost model and ROI
3. Legal/Compliance – scope and claims
4. Executive Briefing – structure and ask clarity

What Scout Preserves (NEVER Invents)

Always Preserved Exactly	Never Invented
Numbers, metrics, percentages	Data Scout doesn't have
Dates, timelines, milestones	Claims not in the source
Names (people, products, systems)	Numbers to "make the story better"
Technical specifications	Fake sources or citations
Cost figures	Speculative outcomes
Source citations	Attribution not in the original

When data is missing: Scout inserts [NEEDS: specific description]

Example: [NEEDS: baseline processing time before automation]

Persona Quick Reference — What Each Expert Hunts For

Persona	Primary Focus	Key Question They Ask
Classic SAM (Wright)	Precision, signal-to-noise	"Is every claim exact?"
Commander (Steele)	Verdict placement, conviction	"Where's the decision?"
Empathetic Holistic (Hart)	Human impact, adoption safety	"What about the people?"
Energetic Collaborative (Cruz)	Momentum, win visibility	"Where's the celebration?"
Skeptic-Proof Analyst (Ledger)	Evidence, assumptions	"What's the proof?"
Executive Briefing (Page)	Economy, ask clarity	"What do I approve?"
Documentary Narrator (Atwood)	Through-line, context	"What's the story arc?"
Teacher/Explainer (Bell)	Concept sequencing, clarity	"Will they understand?"
Sales/Pitch (Archer)	Value anchoring, next step	"What's the payoff?"
Journalist (Bradlee)	Source coverage, neutrality	"Where's the evidence?"
Workshop Facilitator (Rowan)	Interaction, reflection	"What does the audience do?"

Persona	Primary Focus	Key Question They Ask
Legal/Compliance (Clarke)	Scope, quantifier precision	"Can this survive audit?"
Scrum Master (Agile)	Iteration, team empowerment	"Where's the feedback loop?"
Product Manager (Product)	User-value alignment, KPIs	"Who benefits and how?"
Security Auditor (Shield)	Trust boundaries, data lifecycle	"Where's the vulnerability?"
Design Critique (Pixel)	Visual hierarchy, cognitive load	"Can the eye find the point?"
Financial Controller (Capital)	ROI, cost basis, scaling	"What's the payback window?"
Change Manager (People)	Training footprint, phased rollout	"How does the team adopt this?"

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Review feels generic	Confirm you attached the persona file AND REVIEW-DOCUMENT.md — Scout needs both
Rewrite changed my facts	Point out the specific change — facts should never change; Scout will correct
Got the whole deck, only wanted one slide	Be explicit: "Review only slide 3 using [persona]"
Persona feels too harsh	Try Empathetic Holistic or Teacher/Explainer — match persona to your tolerance
Persona feels too soft	Try Commander or Skeptic-Proof Analyst — they don't soften
Don't know which persona to use	Describe your audience and goal — Scout will recommend
Output is too long	Ask: "Summarize findings as a bullet list, top 3 only"
Need more detail on one finding	Ask: "Expand on finding #2 with a full rewrite of that section"

File Checklist

Every session needs these three files:

- ☐ **The persona file** (e.g., `02-COMMANDER-SAM-PERSONA.md`) — tells Scout which expert to become
- ☐ **REVIEW-DOCUMENT.md** or **REWRITE-DOCUMENT.md** — tells Scout what task to perform
- ☐ **Your document** (pptx, docx, md, pdf, or paste text) — the content that gets reviewed or rewritten

Optional:

- ☐ **Context files** — background docs, prior versions, or audience description that helps Scout understand the bigger picture

